Lab 2: Managed Connectors in Lakeflow Connect

Lab Name

Managed Connectors in Lakeflow Connect

Lab Summary

In this lab, we explore **Managed Connectors in Lakeflow Connect** within Databricks. Managed connectors simplify the process of connecting external data sources to Databricks by providing a **UI-based configuration instead of manual coding**.

Databricks provides **5 native managed connectors** such as Salesforce, ServiceNow, Google Analytics, Workday Reports, and SQL Server. Additionally, Databricks integrates with **Fivetran**, a third-party ETL service that provides **100+ connectors** to ingest data from various external systems.

This lab demonstrates how to navigate and configure these connectors from the Databricks interface.

Prerequisites

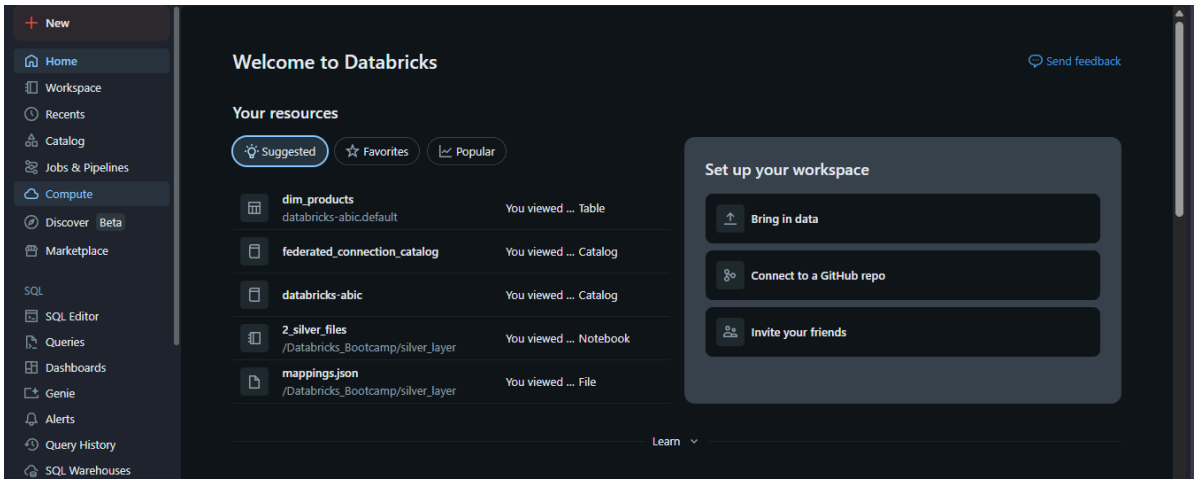
- Databricks Workspace access
- Data Engineering workspace enabled
- Unity Catalog enabled
- Serverless compute enabled
- (Optional) Access to external systems such as ServiceNow or SQL Server

Steps to Complete Lab

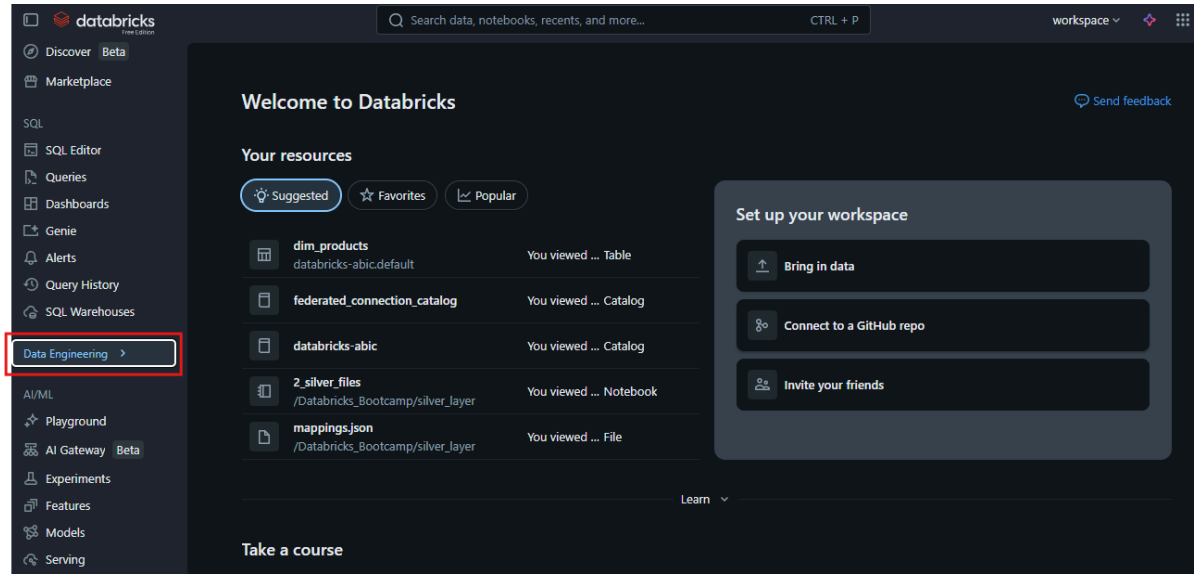
Task 1 – Navigate to Data Ingestion

Sub-task 1.1 – Open Data Engineering Section

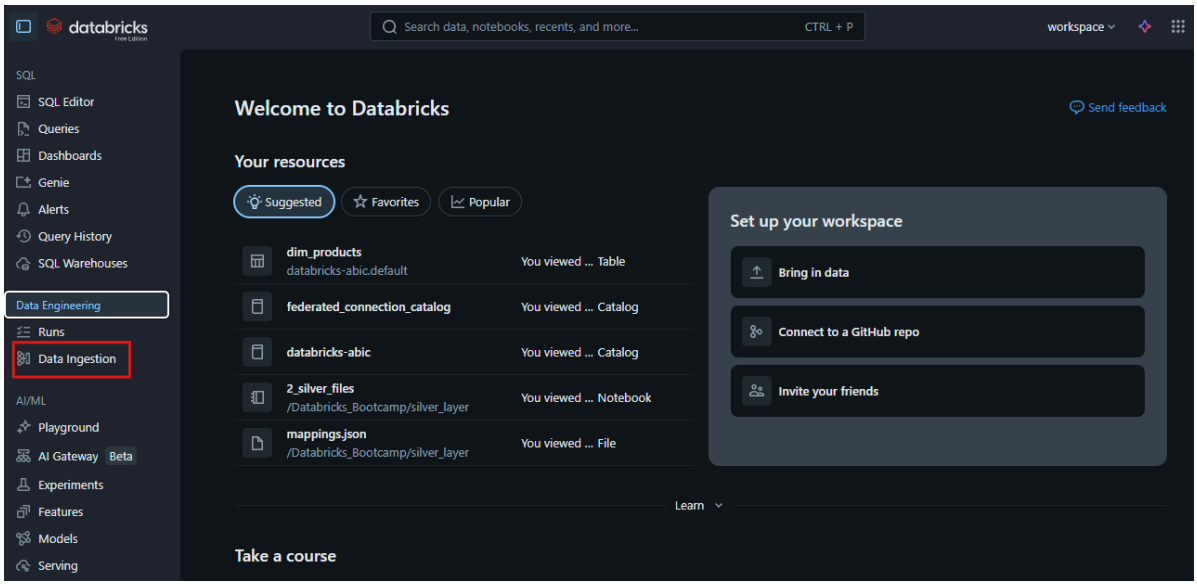
1. Open **Databricks Workspace**



2. Go to **Data Engineering**



3. Click **Data Ingestion**



Alternative path:

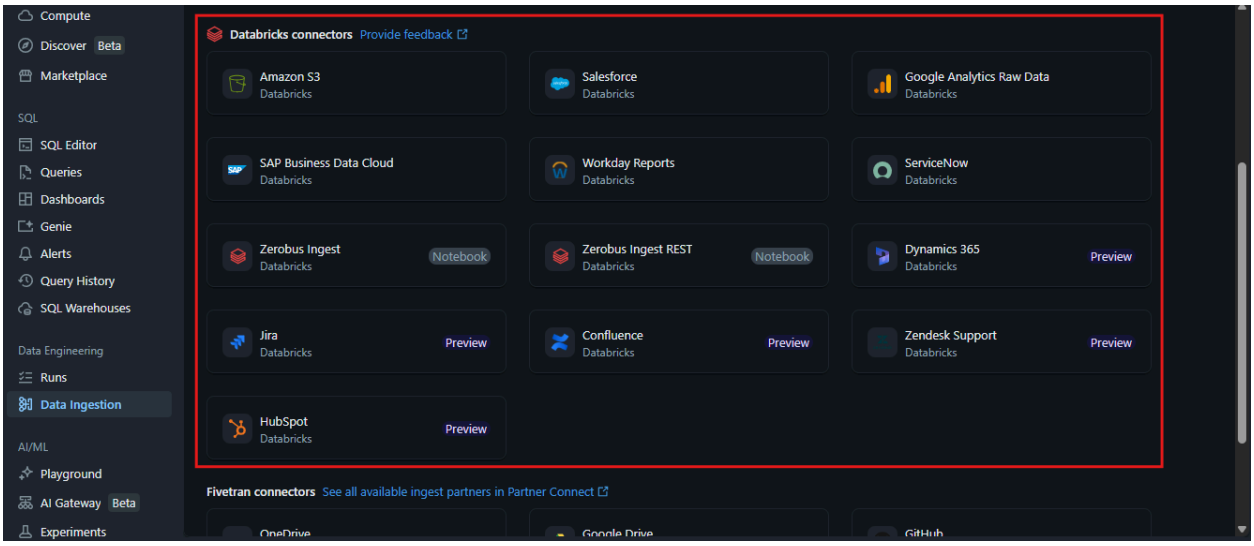
1. Go to **Jobs & Pipelines**
2. Click **Data Ingestion**

This section contains the **Lakeflow Connect ingestion tools**.

Task 2 – Explore Databricks Native Managed Connectors

Sub-task 2.1 – Locate Databricks Connectors

At the top of the **Data Ingestion page**, you will see **Databricks Connectors**.



Databricks currently provides several **native managed connectors** including:

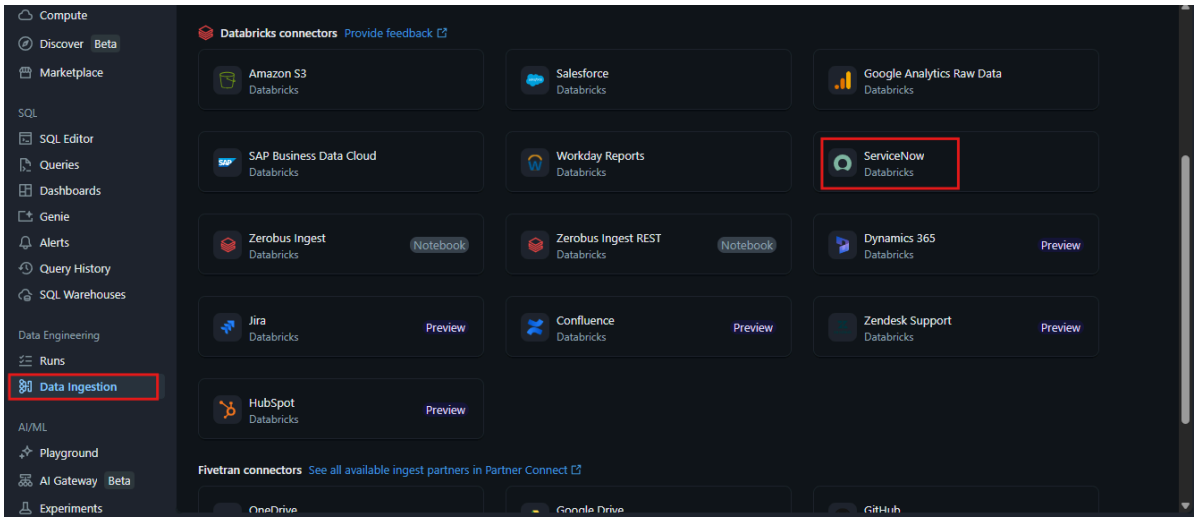
- Salesforce
- Workday Reports
- ServiceNow
- Google Analytics

These connectors simplify connecting Databricks with external systems.

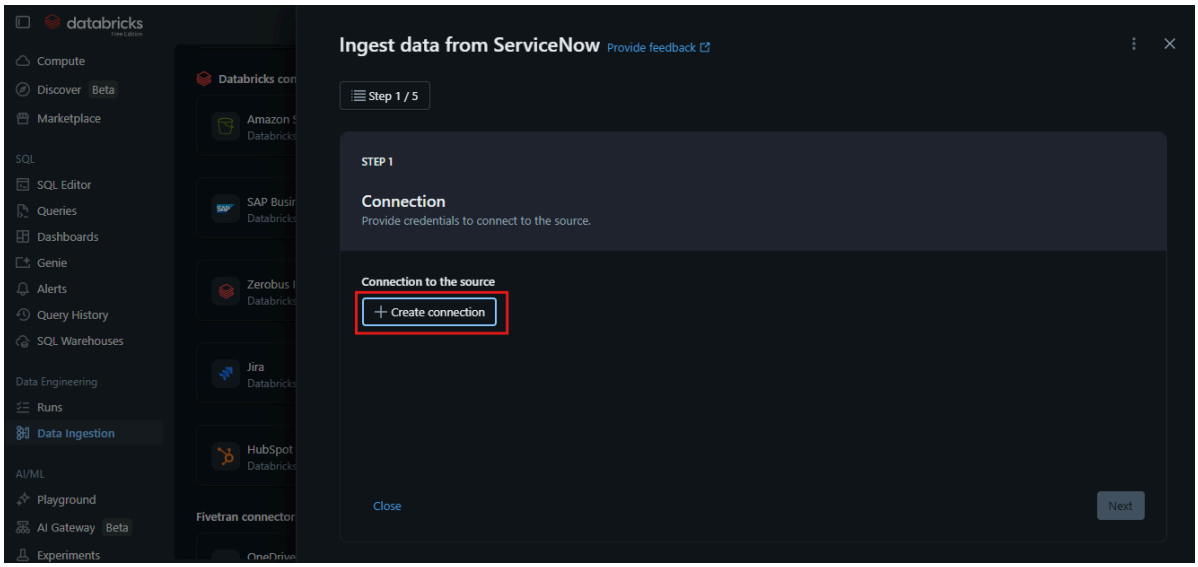
Sub-task 2.2 – Configure a Connector Example

Example: **ServiceNow Connector**

1. Click **ServiceNow**

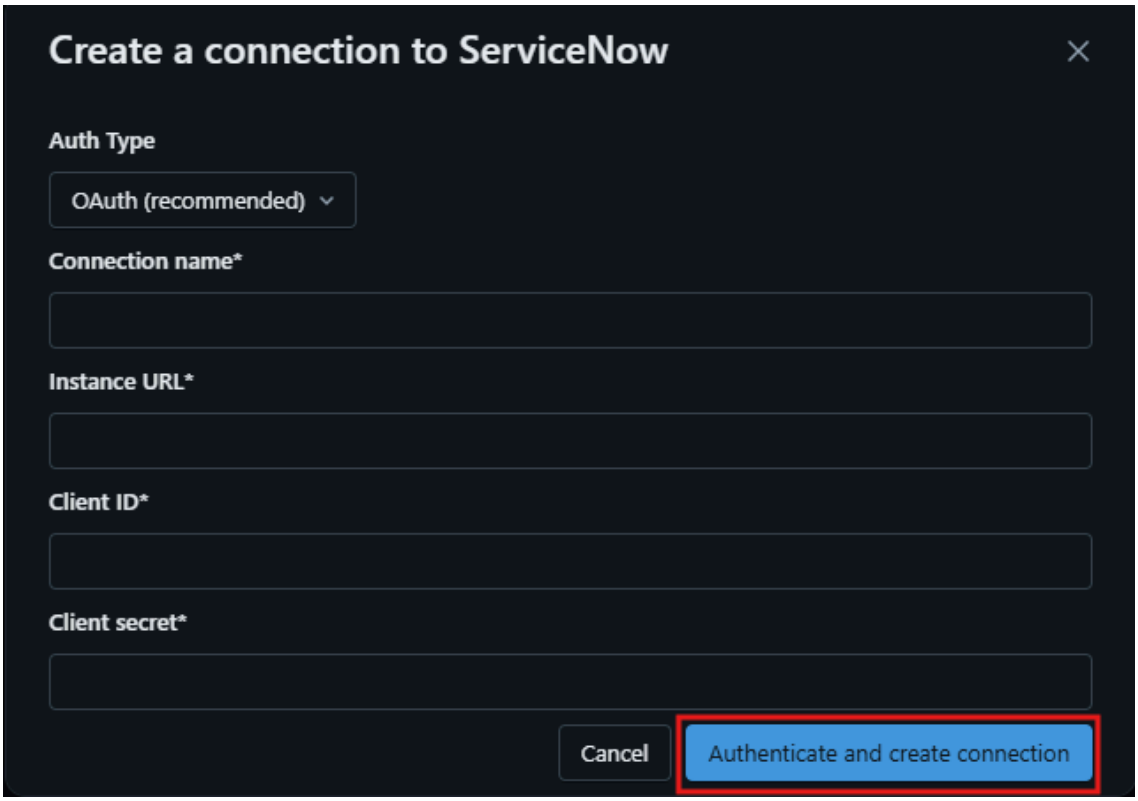


2. Click **Create Connection**



3. Provide the following details:

- **Auth Type:** OAuth (recommended)
- **Connection name**
- **Instance URL**
- **Client ID**
- **Client secret**



4. Provide the required configuration details:
   - **Pipeline Name**
   - **Source System**
   - **Destination Catalog / Schema**
5. Create the pipeline to ingest data

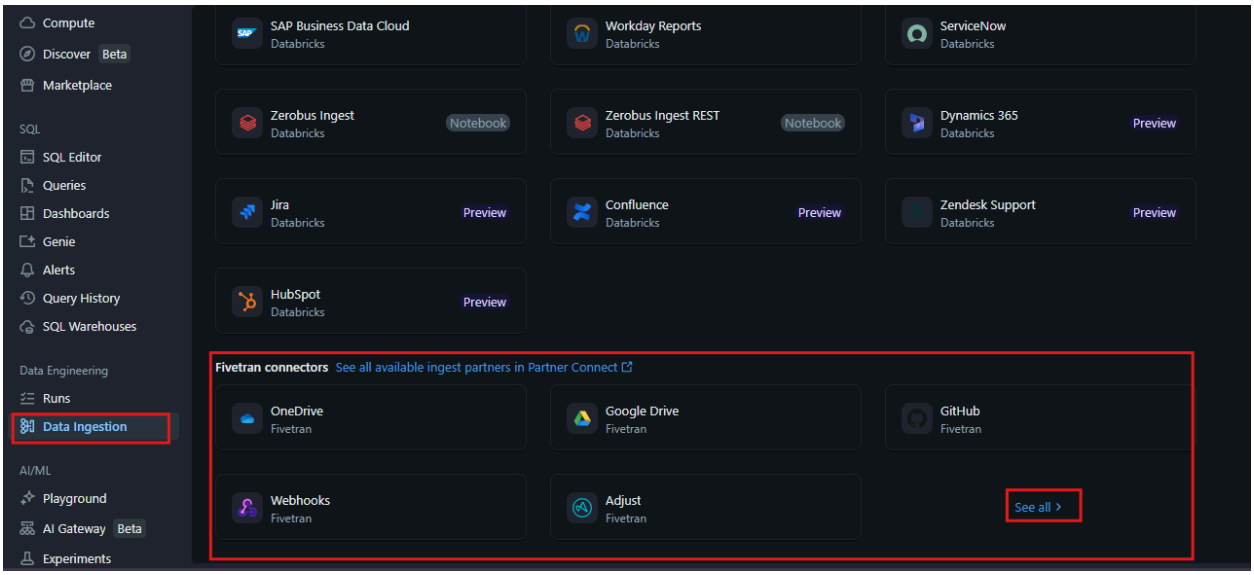
If valid credentials are provided, Databricks will **automatically pull data into Delta tables**.

Task 3 – Explore Fivetran Managed Connectors

Sub-task 3.1 – View Third-Party Connectors

1. Scroll down in the **Data Ingestion page**
2. Locate **Fivetran Connectors**

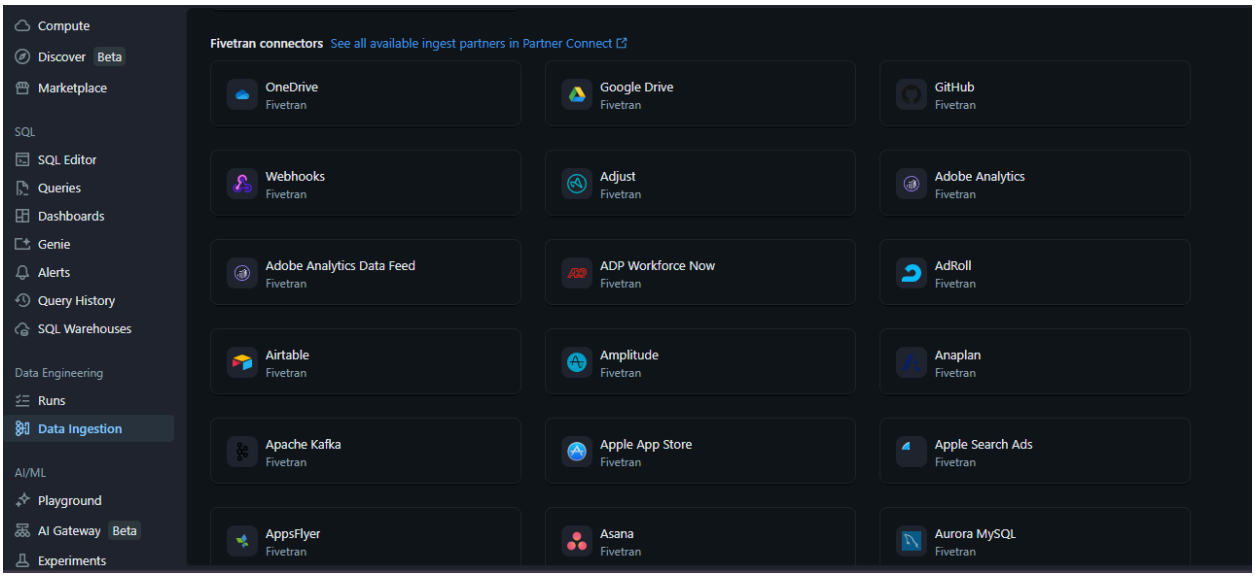
3. Click **See All**



You will see **100+ connectors** available for various systems.

Examples include:

- PostgreSQL
- MySQL
- Snowflake
- SAP
- HubSpot
- Shopify
- MongoDB
- Oracle
- Stripe



These connectors are powered by **Fivetran**, a third-party ETL service.

Sub-task 3.2 – Configure a Fivetran Connector

1. Select any connector
2. Provide:
    - Source credentials
    - Destination configuration
3. Fivetran will automatically:
    - Extract data
    - Load it into Databricks
    - Store it in **Delta tables**

Outcome

After completing this lab, you can:

- Understand **Managed Connectors in Lakeflow Connect**
- Identify **Databricks native connectors**
- Explore **Fivetran third-party connectors**

- Configure connectors using **UI-based ingestion**
- Understand how Databricks simplifies external data ingestion